

Backend Software Engineer

Do not advance

Candidate: Emma Carter

Date: 2026-08-13

Interview language: English

Executive summary

The candidate was unable to answer any questions regarding their technical background or past projects, repeatedly stating they could not remember. Consequently, none of the key requirements for the Backend Software Engineer role could be verified.

Competency scorecard

COMPETENCY	RATING	JUSTIFICATION
Distributed Systems & Microservices Migration TECHNICAL	Weak	When asked about the criteria used to define service boundaries for the monolith-to-microservices migration at Fenwick Logistics, the candidate stated they did not remember and asked to move to the next question.
Python & API Performance TECHNICAL	Weak	The candidate could not describe any of the caching patterns or query optimizations claimed on their résumé to reduce API p95 latency, stating they did not remember.
Ownership & Production Accountability GENERAL	Weak	The candidate was unable to recall any details of the CI/CD pipeline migration from Jenkins to GitHub Actions they claimed to have owned, requesting to skip the question.

Strengths

Concerns

- Unable to explain the service boundary criteria for their claimed microservices migration.
- Failed to recall any caching patterns or query optimizations despite claiming to have reduced API latency using Redis.
- Could not provide any details on the CI/CD pipeline migration they claimed to have owned.
- Repeatedly declined to answer questions, stating they did not remember.

Résumé vs. interview — reality check

The candidate's live interview completely contradicted and failed to substantiate their résumé. They were unable to speak to any of the major achievements listed under their experience at Fenwick Logistics, including the microservices migration, Redis optimizations, and CI/CD ownership.

Panel perspectives

Alex

Alex probed the candidate's technical claims regarding microservices migration and API performance. The candidate was unable to provide any technical details, criteria, or patterns, repeatedly stating they did not remember.

Sara

Sara evaluated the candidate's general background and ownership mindset, specifically focusing on their claimed CI/CD pipeline migration. The candidate refused to answer, showing no ability to discuss their past work.

Both interviewers encountered the same barrier: the candidate was completely unable to recall or discuss any details of their past projects. Their perspectives reinforce each other perfectly, confirming that the candidate cannot substantiate any claims on their résumé.

Recommendation & next steps

Reject the candidate immediately. They did not demonstrate any of the required technical knowledge or experience during the interview.

Full transcript

Q1. Hello. Thank you for your time today. My name is Alex. I will be conducting this interview for the Backend Software Engineer position at Northwind Analytics. My colleague, Sara, is also joining us today.

(no answer recorded)

Q2. Hello. My name is Sara, and I am part of the people operations team. I will be leading our conversation today. To begin, could you please introduce yourself, and share a brief overview of your background and what led you to apply for this position?

Yes I have 5 years of experience that led me to apply

Q3. Thank you. Five years of experience is a strong foundation. Given that background, I would like to know more about the systems you have built. Our team is currently migrating from a monolith to an event-driven microservices architecture. In your previous roles, have you worked on a similar transition, or managed distributed systems in production?

I dont remember next question please

Q4. Understood. We can certainly move on. With your five years of experience, you have likely worked closely with relational databases. Could you tell me about a database design or optimization challenge you resolved in a previous project?

I dont remember next question please

Q5. I understand. Let us focus on a specific project from your resume. At Fenwick Logistics, you led the migration of an order-processing monolith into six microservices. Could you explain the criteria you used to define the boundaries for those six services?

Distributed Systems & Microservices Migration

I dont remember next question please

Q6. I see. Let us move on to a different area of your experience. Your résumé mentions that you reduced average API p95 latency at Fenwick Logistics by improving your caching strategy around Redis. Could you describe the specific caching patterns or query optimizations you implemented to achieve that?

Python & API Performance

I dont remember next question please

“I dont remember next question please”

Q7. I understand. Let us proceed to another aspect of your experience. Your résumé notes that you owned the CI/CD pipeline migration from Jenkins to GitHub Actions. Could you explain how you planned this transition to minimize disruption for the engineering team?

Ownership & Production Accountability

I dont remember next question please

“I dont remember next question please”

Q8. Thank you very much for your time today. It was a pleasure speaking with you. As we wrap up our conversation, I would like to ask if you have any questions for me about the Backend Software Engineer role, or about our company.

no question thanks

Q9. Thank you very much for your time today. It was a pleasure learning more about your background and experience. We will be in touch soon regarding the next steps of the process. Have a pleasant rest of your day.

(no answer recorded)

Every recommendation from Mensetsu AI is a starting point for your team's journey to the right candidate.